

# Market Pricing Analysis for Proposal Services

Midwest **small-to-midsize companies (\$2-\$5 million gross profit)** that are new to marketing typically operate with limited marketing budgets. In fact, about *59% of businesses spend under \$3,500 per month on all outsourced marketing services* <sup>1</sup>. Such firms often seek cost-effective solutions and may balk at pricing on the higher end of industry averages. Below, we compare the **proposal's service prices** against market norms for similar businesses, and then provide a table of **typical price ranges** for each of the **8 marketing services** across freelancers, boutique agencies, and full-service agencies. All figures assume **monthly rates or one-time project fees** appropriate for **small businesses in the Midwest**.

## Proposal Pricing vs. Market Averages

The table below lists each service from the proposal, with an approximate **typical price range** for small businesses and guidance on whether the proposal's price might be *too high or too low* relative to the market. (Without the exact proposal numbers, we indicate thresholds for potential overpricing or underpricing based on industry data.)

| Service                                      | Typical Range (Small Biz)                                                     | Proposal Price – High or Low?                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Search Engine Optimization (SEO)</b>      | ~\$500 – \$2,500 per month <sup>2</sup> <sup>3</sup>                          | <i>If your SEO fee is above ~\$2.5k, it's higher than what many small firms pay (may seem expensive). Below ~\$500/mo could be too low to cover robust SEO</i> <sup>3</sup> .      |
| <b>Pay-Per-Click (PPC) Ads Management</b>    | ~\$300 – \$1,500 per month (or ~10–20% of ad spend) <sup>4</sup> <sup>5</sup> | <i>Fees over ~\$1.5k/mo (or &gt;20% of ad budget) would be high for modest ad spends</i> <sup>4</sup> . Under ~\$300 could indicate limited service scope.                         |
| <b>Social Media Management</b>               | ~\$500 – \$2,000 per month <sup>6</sup> <sup>7</sup>                          | <i>Above ~\$2k/month for social media is high for small-business budgets</i> <sup>6</sup> . Below ~\$500 (for multi-platform management) may undervalue the work.                  |
| <b>Email Marketing</b>                       | ~\$300 – \$1,000 per month <sup>8</sup> <sup>9</sup>                          | <i>Pricing over ~\$1k/month for email campaigns would be on the high side for small firms</i> <sup>8</sup> . Under ~\$300 might signal very basic service or fewer emails.         |
| <b>Content Marketing (Blogs/Content)</b>     | ~\$1,000 – \$5,000 per month <sup>10</sup> <sup>11</sup>                      | <i>Exceeding ~\$5k/month for content (e.g. blogs, articles) is above average for small businesses</i> <sup>10</sup> . Under ~\$1k/month (only a couple of posts) may limit impact. |
| <b>Website Design/Development (one-time)</b> | ~\$3,000 – \$10,000 project fee <sup>12</sup>                                 | <i>Quotes much above ~\$10k for an SMB website are likely too high</i> <sup>12</sup> . Under ~\$3k may be feasible only for simple template sites.                                 |

| Service                                         | Typical Range (Small Biz)                                | Proposal Price – High or Low?                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Branding/Graphic Design</b> (e.g. logo)      | ~\$1,000 – \$5,000 project fee <sup>13</sup>             | <i>Above ~\$5k for a logo/branding package is high for small businesses <sup>13</sup>. Under ~\$1k could be below market for professional design work.</i> |
| <b>Marketing Strategy Consulting</b> (one-time) | ~\$3,000 – \$10,000 for a strategy project <sup>14</sup> | <i>More than ~\$10k for a marketing plan or strategy is expensive at this scale <sup>14</sup>. Below ~\$3k might indicate a very limited engagement.</i>   |

**Note:** Companies with no prior marketing spend may perceive even “typical” rates as high. A proposal priced at the **upper end** of the ranges above could face resistance, while pricing at the **lower end** might win business but risk undervaluing services. Strive for a balance – competitive yet sustainable pricing – and communicate the **ROI** to justify higher fees when needed.

## Market Price Ranges by Service and Provider Type

To refine your pricing structure, the table below shows **typical price ranges** for each of the 8 services, broken down by type of provider: a **freelancer** (or solo contractor), a **boutique agency** (small specialized agency with lower overhead), and a **full-service agency** (larger firm with broad capabilities). These ranges are drawn from industry surveys and reports, focusing on mid-2020s data for small and mid-sized business marketing:

| Service                                                                                              | Freelancer / Solo                                                                                                                                             | Boutique Agency                                                                                                                                       | Full-Service Agency                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>SEO (monthly)</b> – Ongoing search optimization of a small business site.                         | <b>\$500 – \$1,000/mo</b> (often hourly ~\$50–\$100) <sup>15</sup> <sup>3</sup> . Lower overhead allows cheaper rates, but scope may be limited.              | <b>\$1,000 – \$2,500/mo</b> (typical SMB retainer) <sup>2</sup> . Covers on-page, some content & link-building; balanced cost vs. expertise.          | <b>\$2,500 – \$5,000+/mo</b> (for extensive SEO) <sup>3</sup> . Top agencies or competitive industries can hit \$5k+ (even \$7k+) <sup>3</sup> .            |
| <b>PPC Management (monthly)</b> – Managing Google Ads/Microsoft Ads campaigns (management fee only). | <b>\$300 – \$1,000/mo</b> (or ~10% of ad spend). Many freelancers charge a small flat fee or lower percentage for small budgets <sup>16</sup> <sup>17</sup> . | <b>\$500 – \$2,000/mo</b> (or ~15% of spend). Small agencies often use a minimum fee (e.g. \$500+) or ~15–20% of ad spend <sup>4</sup> <sup>5</sup> . | <b>\$2,000 – \$5,000/mo</b> (10–20% on larger budgets) <sup>4</sup> . Full agencies often have higher minimums or fees scaling to ~\$10k for big ad spends. |

| Service                                                                                            | Freelancer / Solo                                                                                                                                                                        | Boutique Agency                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Full-Service Agency                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Social Media Management (monthly)</b> – Content creation, posting, and engagement on platforms. | <b>\$500 – \$1,500/mo.</b> A freelance social media manager might charge ~\$500 per platform or a flat monthly rate in this range <sup>7</sup> <sup>18</sup> .                           | <b>\$1,500 – \$4,000/mo.</b> Boutique agencies handling multi-platform social campaigns (incl. content & customer service) often fall here <sup>18</sup> <sup>6</sup> .                                                                        | <b>\$4,000 – \$10,000/mo.</b> Large agencies may charge several thousand for comprehensive social media programs, especially if including ad management <sup>19</sup> <sup>20</sup> .                                                                              |
| <b>Email Marketing</b> (monthly management of campaigns/newsletters)                               | <b>\$200 – \$800/mo.</b> A freelancer might bill a few hours per month to design/write emails – small businesses pay on the lower end if volume is low <sup>8</sup> <sup>21</sup> .      | <b>\$500 – \$1,500/mo.</b> A boutique agency often charges in this range for managing regular email campaigns with automation and design <sup>22</sup> <sup>8</sup> . (Many small firms spend ~\$300–\$1k on email marketing <sup>8</sup> .)   | <b>\$1,500 – \$5,000/mo.</b> Full-service agencies may handle large lists, complex automation, and frequent sends, costing a few thousand per month <sup>21</sup> <sup>22</sup> . (High-end specialized email agencies often start around \$2k/mo <sup>23</sup> .) |
| <b>Content Marketing</b> – Ongoing content creation (e.g. blog posts, infographics) per month.     | <b>\$500 – \$2,000/mo.</b> Freelance writers might charge ~\$250–\$500 per blog post <sup>24</sup> ; a few posts a month or occasional graphics would total in this range.               | <b>\$2,000 – \$5,000/mo.</b> Small agencies often offer content packages here (e.g. 4–8 blogs/month plus promotion). Many businesses budget ~\$5k on content monthly on average <sup>10</sup> .                                                | <b>\$5,000 – \$10,000/mo.</b> A larger agency content program (strategy, multiple high-quality articles, videos, infographics) can run well into five figures <sup>10</sup> <sup>11</sup> . Enterprise content marketing can even exceed this if volume is high.   |
| <b>Website Design/Development – (Project-based)</b> Designing a new SMB website or major redesign. | <b>\$500 – \$5,000</b> (one-time). A freelance web designer might build a simple small-business site in this range <sup>12</sup> . Using templates or limited features keeps costs down. | <b>\$3,000 – \$10,000</b> (project). A boutique agency will custom-design a professional site in this range for a small business <sup>12</sup> . (Typical <b>small biz website</b> cost ~\$1k–\$10k depending on requirements <sup>25</sup> .) | <b>\$10,000 – \$50,000+.</b> Full agencies charge a premium for fully custom, complex sites <sup>26</sup> <sup>12</sup> . Small firms rarely need these top-tier builds, but a robust e-commerce or custom solution could approach this level.                     |

| Service                                                                                                    | Freelancer / Solo                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Boutique Agency                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Full-Service Agency                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Branding &amp; Graphic Design – (Project-based)</b><br>Logo design, brand identity, graphics.           | <b>\$100 – \$1,000</b> (one-time). Less-experienced freelancers may charge a few hundred for a logo; some freelancers start ~\$100 for basic designs <sup>27</sup> <sup>28</sup> . Quality and experience vary widely at this tier. | <b>\$1,000 – \$5,000</b> (project). A specialized boutique agency typically charges in the low thousands for a complete branding package (logo, style guide, etc.) <sup>13</sup> . This range covers most <b>small biz branding</b> needs with professional results. | <b>\$5,000 – \$50,000+</b> . Renowned agencies can charge tens of thousands for comprehensive branding work <sup>29</sup> <sup>28</sup> . (Small businesses seldom invest this much; ~\$5k is usually the high end for local firms <sup>13</sup> .)                     |
| <b>Marketing Strategy Consulting – (Project-based)</b><br>Developing a marketing plan or strategy roadmap. | <b>\$1,000 – \$3,000</b> (for a short engagement). An independent marketing consultant might charge a few thousand for a basic marketing plan or one-time audit for a small company.                                                | <b>\$3,000 – \$8,000</b> . Boutique agencies often quote in this range for a comprehensive marketing strategy project or workshop series tailored to an SMB <sup>14</sup> .                                                                                          | <b>\$8,000 – \$15,000</b> . A full-service agency's strategic engagement (market research, full plan across channels) can cost five figures <sup>14</sup> . Extensive strategy projects for mid-sized clients tend to fall near the upper end of ~\$10k <sup>14</sup> . |

**Sources:** The ranges above are synthesized from recent industry surveys and pricing guides. For example, SEO services average **\$500–\$7,500/mo** overall <sup>3</sup> , but many small businesses stick to the low end (even <\$1,000). PPC management is often **10–20% of ad spend** (with ~\$1,500/mo common) <sup>4</sup> . Social media management typically runs **\$500–\$5,000+** monthly depending on scope <sup>6</sup> . Email marketing agency fees for small firms cluster around **\$300–\$1,000/mo** <sup>8</sup> . Most businesses allocate **\$5k–\$10k/mo to content marketing** on average <sup>10</sup> . A **small-business website** built by a freelancer or small shop can cost **a few thousand dollars** <sup>12</sup> , whereas top agencies charge far more. Logo design by freelancers might be **<\$1k**, versus **\$1k–\$5k** via a small agency and up to tens of thousands at elite firms <sup>13</sup> <sup>28</sup> . Developing a **marketing strategy** can range from a couple grand by a solo consultant to **\$3k–\$10k** or more with an experienced agency <sup>14</sup> .

## Conclusion and Recommendations

Overall, **benchmarking your proposal against market rates** suggests checking each service for alignment with what cost-sensitive small businesses expect to pay. If several of your prices sit at or above the high end of the typical ranges, the **package may feel expensive** to Midwest clients new to marketing. In that case, consider adjusting the scope or offering tiered options (e.g. a “starter” package vs. an advanced plan) to provide a lower entry point <sup>21</sup> <sup>30</sup> . On the other hand, if any prices are well **below market averages**, ensure you’re not undervaluing your work – extremely low fees could raise questions about quality or cut into your margins.

When finalizing your **price structure**, leverage the distinctions between provider types: for instance, you might position your agency's fees as a middle ground – offering more expertise than a solo freelancer but at a better price than large agencies. Emphasize value and ROI for each service. Small businesses with no marketing history may need education on **marketing's benefits**; transparently showing how your pricing leads to business growth will help justify appropriate rates. With a data-informed pricing strategy spanning all 8 services, you can remain **competitive** while still being **profitable**, ultimately creating a win-win for both your agency and your small business clients. 30 1

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